

Street Fighter 6 (SF6) is a golden standard for what a modern fighting game should be. SF6 successfully brought in new players, as it took giant leaps in tackling the entry barrier of fighting games and did many things to streamline the learning process.

The streamlined controls they added, which they labeled as "Modern controls" (Modern) were an innovative approach to the simplified controls idea, as it gives the option for "easier" controls with clear downsides in the form of reduced damage and a smaller pool of moves. It replaces your typical six attack buttons (Light, Medium, Heavy, punches and kicks) into four attack buttons (Light, Medium, Heavy attack, and special). By changing the button layout, Modern creates a simpler control scheme for new players to understand and play on while using a traditional controller. The previous SF games were designed around the use of an arcade stick, making the layout on a controller feel odd.

From Modern's button layout, players can learn the value of when each attack should be used, not having to focus on what specific move needs to be used and when. Players would learn that, generally, lights are used to interrupt enemy attacks, mediums are used to poke and start combos, and heavys are used to punish enemies' mistakes and lead to even bigger combos. The special button allows for the use of special moves without needing motion inputs, allowing a new player to use an essential part of a character's toolkit with ease.

A motion input is a combination of directions required to input certain moves. The removal of motion inputs lowers the barrier to entry into the genre, allowing more new players.

Unlike previously attempted simplified control schemes, they do not play the game for you. Modern controls are viable at a competitive level. The player does not play a different game when picking Modern; instead, they can focus less on the execution of moves and more on what strategies they want to apply in a match. This simultaneously solves the issue of having to learn "complex" motions to play the game in its most basic form while also giving more experienced players a new system to master if they wish to. Some professional players use Modern instead of Classic. Modern has very clear strengths and weaknesses, allowing for strategies that would not have previously been possible.

An example of an in-game benefit to Modern is "instant" reactions. Instant reactions are only possible because Modern does not require motion inputs. Inputting motion inputs, no matter how skilled you are at doing them, requires time to do. With Modern, all that is necessary is pressing multiple buttons simultaneously so that, in comparison to Classic, you can input a move immediately on reaction—giving modern players a considerable advantage and allowing them to play the game differently. However, the downside is that the player loses access to a good portion of their moves, which limits their overall options and game plan.

Clear benefits and downsides are why Modern controls are a success, as they become an alternative way of playing for players. It also simplifies the traditional control scheme, allowing new players to learn Modern first, then, once they get more invested in the game, either stick with it if they prefer it or transition into learning Classic controls for more flexibility and options.